MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DEVOPS & PLATFORM ENGINEERING | QA AUTOMATION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including recent hands-on work in CI/CD, Kubernetes-based test environments, infrastructure tooling and observability. Owns GitLab CI pipelines serving three product teams and has delivered ephemeral environments, measurable pipeline improvements and test metrics dashboards. Builds personal Kubernetes and GitOps infrastructure, including Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

CORE SKILLS

Infrastructure & delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes, k3s, Argo CD, Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic)
Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; dashboards for test and pipeline metrics
Programming & data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Platforms & tooling: Linux, Git, AWS (EC2 and S3 basics; personal learning)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster, including application services, PostgreSQL and seeded data. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and collected CI test results for Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Wrote an internal guide to how CI works, now used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; develop Helm charts for test environments.

Independent Infrastructure Projects (Personal) | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 cluster running k3s, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform in a personal account; used Ansible at a basic level.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, reproducing bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Delivered short-lived environments for each merge request, deployed via GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.

- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against the environment; automated cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health | 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team, supporting investigation and prioritisation of recurring failures.
- Flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams addressed the most frequent offenders.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | Studying; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)